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**BAFTA'S BEST: FROM A
FAMISHED BRODY TO
MADISON'S MISSTEP**



Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets with Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi yesterday.

UAE and Ukraine ink CEPA deal

Agreement to unlock new avenues for trade, investment, and economic ties

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, President of Ukraine, yesterday attended the signing of the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) between the UAE and Ukraine.

The agreement aims to unlock new avenues for trade, investment, and economic collaboration between the two nations.

Shaikh Mohammad highlighted the significance of the agreement in strengthening the

\$372m

Value of bilateral trade between UAE and Ukraine in 2024

strategic ties between the UAE and Ukraine, advancing bilateral trade, and elevating economic cooperation in line with both countries' aspirations.

Pivotal role

The UAE President expressed confidence that the agreement would play a pivotal role in deepening economic and investment relations between the two countries, thereby contributing to mutual growth and prosperity. He reiterated the UAE's commitment to

strengthening partnerships in efforts to foster sustainable development.

The agreement was signed during a formal ceremony at Qasr Al Shati by Dr Thani Bin Ahmad Al Zeyoudi, UAE Minister of State for Foreign Trade, and Yulia Svyrydenko, First Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Economy of Ukraine.

Under the terms of the CEPA, 99 per cent of Ukrainian imports of UAE goods and 97 per cent of Ukrainian exports to the UAE will be exempt from customs duties with immediate effect.

The agreement is expected to contribute \$369 million to the UAE's GDP and \$874 million to Ukraine's GDP by 2031. Ukraine holds strategic importance for the UAE, with bilateral trade between the two reaching \$372.4 million in 2024. — WAM

13 defence deals worth Dh3.97b signed on Day 1

NINE LOCAL CONTRACTS AT IDEX AND NAVDEX 2025 AMOUNT TO DH3.825B

ABU DHABI

Gulf News Report

The opening day of IDEX and NAVDEX 2025 saw the announcement of 13 deals worth Dh3.97 billion signed with both local and international companies.

The contracts were signed by Tawazun Council, the government entity responsible for acquisition, procurement, and contract management for the Ministry of Defence and security agencies.

The announcement was made during a press conference held by Tawazun Council spokespersons Majed Ahmad Al Jaberi, Mohammad Saif Al Zaabi, and Mahra Belal Al Dhaheri.

IDEX and NAVDEX 2025 are organised by Adnec Group, in association with the Ministry of Defence and Tawazun Council.

Major deals

Al Dhaheri announced that the total value of local contracts on the first day amounted to nine deals worth Dh3.825 billion.

The contracts included an agreement with International Golden Group (IGG) to procure ammunition worth Dh685.8 million and a contract with EDGE Group for a data provisioning programme and smart services valued at Dh399.4 million.

IDEX and NAVDEX 2025 are organised by Adnec Group, in association with the Ministry of Defence and Tawazun Council.

The contracts also included an agreement with Calidus Land Systems to procure a multi-role vehicle MTAV 4X4, worth Dh1.809 billion and a contract with National Marine Dredging Company for the acquisition of unmanned platforms worth Dh299.2 million.

Additionally, an agreement was reached with International Golden Group and MP3 for the procurement of pilot missions, aircraft rescue equipment and spare parts worth Dh309 million. Furthermore, Injazat Data Systems was awarded a contract to provide digital transformation services valued at Dh138.7 million.

Meanwhile, Al Zaabi announced that the total value of the four international contracts was worth Dh143.4 million. These included a contract with Germany's Rheinmetall Electronics to offer technical support for maintenance, repair, spare parts supply, logistics services, and sustainment of the tactical engagement system, worth Dh71.8 million.

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